Lathe, mill and CNC machine maintenance schedule

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For manual lathes and mills and CNC machining centers. Coolant is the part that gets skipped: a refractometer reading takes a minute and tells you whether the mix still matches what the coolant maker calls for.

Typical intervals from manufacturer manuals and published service schedules. Your machine's manual comes first.

Daily / every shift

TASK	HOW OFTEN	NOTES	✓
Way lube tank full, pump putting out oil	Daily	Use the way oil your manual names	
Coolant level	Each shift	More often with through-spindle coolant	
Coolant concentration with a refractometer	Daily	Match the coolant maker's range	
Clear chips from way covers, pan and chip screen	End of each shift		
Drain water from the air line and filter	Daily		
Guards in place and working	Daily		
Manual machines: oil the ways, ball oilers, leadscrew	Daily, before running	Check headstock oil level too	

Weekly

TASK	HOW OFTEN	NOTES	✓
Skim tramp oil off the coolant	Weekly	Remove any oil floating on top	
Clean chip basket and coolant collector	Weekly		
Grease the chuck at each fitting	Daily to weekly	Per your machine	

Monthly

TASK	HOW OFTEN	NOTES	✓
Gearbox oil level	Monthly	CNC spindles with a gearbox	
Inspect way covers, light oil if needed	Monthly		
Belts: wear and tension	Monthly		
Lube lines reaching the ways and ballscrews	Monthly	Trained person	

Every 6 months and yearly

TASK	HOW OFTEN	NOTES	✓
Dump the coolant, clean the tank, refill	Every 6 months	Sooner if it won't hold concentration	
Hoses and lube lines for cracks	Every 6 months		
Check backlash and taper	Yearly	Machines settle, and that shifts geometry	
Change gearbox oil	Yearly	Manual lathe headstocks: per manual, often by hours	
Clean the way lube pump intake screen	Yearly		
Hydraulic oil (if equipped)	Yearly		

Service log: lathe, mill and cnc machine

Machine / unit: _____ Make & model: _____

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DATE	HOURS	WORK DONE	PARTS USED	INITIALS